§ **246.** χ became an aspirate (written **h**) initially before vowels, as OE. Goth. OS. **hund**, OHG. **hunt**, from ***χunđan**, prim. form ***kmtóm**, *hundred*; OE. OS. **hund**, Goth. **hunds**, O.Icel. **hundr**, OHG. **hunt**, from ***χunđaz**, *dog, hound.* Some scholars assume that it also became an aspirate medially between vowels. Upon this assumption it would be difficult to account for the breaking in OE., as OE. **slēan**, from ***sleahan**, older ***slaχan-**, Goth. **slahan**, *to strike, slay*; OE. **swēor**, from ***sweohur**, older ***sweχur**, OHG. **swehur**, *father-in-law.* See §§ **87, 329.**

Medial and final χw became χ in Old Norse and the West Germanic languages, as OS. OHG. **sehan**, OE. **sēon**, O.Icel. **sjā**, from ***seχ(w)an-**, beside Goth. **saíƕan**, *to see*; OS. OHG. **līhan**, OE. **līon**, **lēon**, O.Icel. **ljā**, from ***līχ(w)an-**, beside Goth. **leihƕan**, *to lend*; OS. OHG. **aha**, OE. **ēa** from ***eahu**, beside Goth. **aƕa**, *water, river*; OE. **seah**, OS. OHG. **sah**, beside Goth. **saƕ**, *he saw*; OE. **nēah**, OS. OHG. **nāh**, beside Goth. **nēƕ**, *near.*

§ **247.** The consonants, which arose from the Indg. final explosives (**t, d**), were dropped in prim. Germanic, except after a short accented vowel, as OE. OHG. **bere**, Goth. **baírái**, from an original form ***bheroĩt**, *he may bear.* See § **211.**

§ **248.** Original final **-m** became **-n**, and then it, as also Indg. final **-n**, disappeared in dissyllabic and polysyllabic words during the prim. Germanic period. For examples, see § **211.**

§ **249.** **w** disappeared before **u**, as Goth. **kaúrus** from ***kwuruz**, Gr. βαρύς, *heavy*; OE. **æces**, OHG. **ackus**, from ***ak(w)usi-**, beside Goth. **aqizi**, *axe*; OE. **nacod**, older ***nakud**, OHG. **nackut**, from ***nak(w)uđ-**, beside Goth. **naqaþs**, *naked*; OE. **sund**, *a swimming*, from ***swumda-**, beside inf. **swimman**; OE. pp. **sungen**, beside inf. **swingan**, *to swing.* In verbal forms the **w** was mostly reintroduced in the pret. plural and pp. after the analogy

of forms which regularly had **w**, e. g. pret. pl. **swummon, swungon, swullon,** pp. **swummen, swungen** (beside regular form **sungen**), **swollen,** beside inf. **swimman,** *to swim,* **swingan,** *to swing,* **swellan,** *to swell.* For levelling out in the opposite direction, cp. OE. OS. OHG. **singan,** beside Goth. **siggwan** (regular form), *to sing;* OE. **sincan,** OS. OHG. **sinkan,** beside Goth. **sigqan,** *to sink.* Cp. § **241.**

§ **250.** Initial and medial **sr** became **str,** as OE. **strēam,** O.Icel. **straumr,** OS. OHG. **strōm,** *stream,* cp. Skr. **srávati,** *it flows;* pl. OE. **ēastron,** OHG. **ōstarūn,** *Easter,* cp. Skr. **usrā́,** *dawn;* OE. **sweostor,** Goth. **swistar,** OHG. **swester,** *sister,* with **t** from the weak stem-form, as in the locative singular Goth. **swistr** = prim. Germanic ***swesri** = Skr. dat. **svásrē.**

§ **251.** The remaining Indg. consonants suffered no further material changes which need be mentioned here. Summing up the results of §§ **231–50,** we arrive at the following system of consonants for the close of the prim. Germanic period:—

		Labial.	Inter-dental.	Dental.	Palatal and Guttural.
Explosives	voiceless	**p**		**t**	**k**
	voiced	**b**		**d**	**g**
Spirants	voiceless	**f**	**þ**	**s**	**χ**
	voiced	**ƀ**	**đ**	**z**	**ʒ**
Nasals		**m**		**n**	**ŋ**
Liquids				**l, r**	
Semivowels		**w**			**j** (palatal)

To these must be added the aspirate **h.**

CHAPTER IX

SPECIAL WEST GERMANIC MODIFICATIONS OF THE GENERAL GERMANIC CONSONANT-SYSTEM

§ **252.** Prim. Germanic **z**, which arose from **s** (§ **238**), became **r** medially, and was dropped finally, as OE. **māra**, OHG. **mēro** = Goth. **máiza**, *greater*; pp. OE. **coren**, OHG. **gikoran**, beside inf. OE. **cēosan**, OHG. **kiosan**, *to choose*; OE. **herian**, Goth. **hazjan**, *to praise*; and similarly **hīeran**, *to hear*, **lǣran**, *to teach*; **leornian** from ***liznōjan-**, *to learn*; **nerian**, *to save*; OE. **bet(e)ra**, OS. **betera**, OHG. **bezziro**, Goth. **batiza**, *better*; OE. OS. **hord**, OHG. **hort**, Goth. **huzd**, *hoard, treasure*; OE. **dēor**, OS. **dior**, OHG. **tior**, Goth. **dius** (gen. **diuzis**), prim. Germanic ***đeuzan**, from an original form ***dheusóm**, *deer, wild animal*; OE. **dæg**, OS. **dag**, OHG. **tag** = Goth. **dags**, from ***đaȝaz**, *day*; OE. **giest**, OS. OHG. **gast** = Goth. **gasts**, from ***ȝastiz**, *guest*; OE. OS. OHG. **sunu** = Goth. **sunus**, from ***sunuz**, *son*; pl. OE. **giefa**, OS. **geþa**, OHG. **gebā** = Goth. **gibōs**, from ***ȝeþõz**, *gifts*; OE. **guman** = Goth. **gumans**, from ***ȝomaniz**, cp. Lat. **homines**, *men*; OE. **men(n)** = Goth. **mans**, from ***maniz**, *men*; adv. OE. OS. **bet**, O.Icel. **betr**, from ***batiz**, *better*; OE. OS. **leng**, O.Icel. **lengr**, from ***laŋgiz**, *longer*. The following OE. pronouns are developed from original unstressed forms where **-s** became **-z** and then disappeared, whereas in OHG. the **-z** became **-r** in these words: **gē**, OS. **gī**, Goth. **jus**, *ye*; **hwā**, OS. **hwē**, OHG. **hwer**, Goth. **hʷas**, *who?*; dat. **mē**, OS. **mī**, OHG. **mir**, Goth. **mis**, *me*; dat. **þē**, OS. **thī**, OHG. **dir**, Goth. **þus**, *thee*; **wē**, OS. **wī**, OHG. **wir**, Goth. **weis**, *we*. It is difficult to account for the loss of

the final consonant in the OE. adv. **mā**, Goth. **máis**, from ***maisiz**, *more*.

§ **253.** Prim. Germanic **đ** (§§ **234, 238**) became **d**, which was shifted to **t** in OHG., as OE. **bēodan**, OS. **biodan**, OHG. **biotan**, *to offer*; OE **fæder**, OS. **fadar**, OHG. **fater**, *father*; OE. **mōdor**, OS. **mōdar**, OHG. **muoter**, *mother*; OE. **healdan**, OS. **haldan**, OHG. **haltan**, *to hold*; pp. OE. **worden**, OS. **wordan**, OHG. **wortan**, beside inf. OE. **weorþan**, *to become*; OE. OS. **god**, OHG. **got**, *God*; OE. OS. **word**, OHG. **wort**, *word*.

§ **254.** All single consonants, except **r**, were doubled after a short vowel before a following **j**. This **j** was mostly retained in Old Saxon, but was generally dropped in OE. and OHG. **þj, đj, gj** became **bb, dd, gg** (generally written **cg** in OE.). Examples are: OE. **hliehhan**, OS. ***hlahhian**, OHG. **hlahhen** = Goth. **hlahjan**, *to laugh*; OE. **lecgan**, OS. **leggian**, OHG. **leggen** = Goth. **lagjan**, *to lay*; OE. **settan**, OS. **settian**, OHG. **setzen** = Goth. **satjan**, *to set*; OE. **scieppan**, OS. **skeppian**, OHG. **skephen** = Goth. **skapjan**, *to create*; and similarly OE. **biddan**, *to pray*; **fremman**, *to perform*; **licgan**, *to lie down*; **sceþþan**, *to injure*; **sellan**, *to sell, give*; **sittan**, *to sit*; **swebban**, *to lull to sleep*; **þennan**, *to stretch*; **þridda** (Goth. **þridja**), *third*; **hell** (Goth. **halja**), *hell*; **sibb** (Goth. **sibja**), *relationship*; gen. **cynnes** (Goth. **kunjis**), *of a race, generation*; and similarly **brycg**, *bridge*; **cribb**, *crib, stall*; **crycc**, *crutch*; **henn**, *hen*. But OE. OS. **nerian**, OHG. **nerien** = Goth. **nasjan**, *to save*; OE. **herian** = Goth. **hazjan**, *to praise*. For examples of West Germanic **ww** from **wj**, see § **90**.

NOTE.—1. The **j** in the combination **ji** had disappeared before the West Germanic doubling of consonants took place, e. g. in the 2. and 3. pers. sing. of the pres. indicative, as OE. **legest, legeþ**, OS. **legis, legid**, OHG. **legis, legit** = Goth. **lagjis, lagjiþ**, beside inf. OE. **lecgan**, OS. **leggian**, OHG. **leggen**, Goth. **lagjan**, *to lay*.

2. The sing. nom. and acc. of neuter nouns like **bedd** (Goth. nom. **badi**, gen. **badjis**), *bed*, **cynn** (Goth. **kuni**), *race, generation*; **nett** (Goth. **nati**), *net*, had their double consonants from the inflected forms, see § **274**.

§ **255**. **p, t, k,** and **h** (= χ) were also doubled in West Germanic before a following **r** or **l**. The doubling regularly took place in the inflected forms (as gen. OE. OS. OHG. **bittres**, OE. **æpples**, OS. **apples**, OHG. **aphles**), and was then generally transferred to the uninflected forms by levelling, as OE. **bitter** (**biter**), OS. OHG. **bittar**, cp. Goth. **báitrs**, *bitter*; OE. **hlŭttor** (**hlūtor**), OS. **hluttar**, OHG. **hlūttar**, cp. Goth. **hlūtrs**, *clear, pure*; OHG. **kupfar**, beside OE **copor**, Lat. **cuprum**, *copper*; OE. **snottor** (**snotor**), OS. OHG. **snottar**, cp. Goth. **snutrs**, *wise*; OE. **wæccer** (**wæcer**, **wacor**), OHG. **wackar**, *watchful*; OS. **akkar**, OHG. **ackar**, beside OE. **æcer**, cp. Goth. **akrs**, *field*; OE. **æppel** (**æpl**), OS. **appul**, OHG. **aphul**, cp. O.Icel. **epli**, *apple*; OS. **luttil**, OHG. **lutzil**, beside OE. **lȳtel**, *little*. In some words double forms arose through levelling out in different directions; thus regular forms were nom. sing. **tēar** (= OHG. **zahar**) from ***teahur**, older ***taχur**, *tear*, gen. ***teahhres** (Nth. **tæhhres**), nom. pl. ***teahhras** (Nth. **tæhhras**). From **tæhhres, tæhhras**, &c., was formed a new nom. sing. **tæhher** in Nth., whereas the other dialects generalized **tēar**, whence gen. sing. **tēares**, nom. pl. **tēaras**. In like manner arose **ēar** beside Nth. **æhher**, *ear of corn*; **gēol** beside **geohhol**, *Yule, Christmas*. See §§ **219, 260**.

§ **256**. Doubling of consonants also regularly took place before a following **n** in the weak declension of nouns, as sing. nom. ***knotō**, *knot*, acc. ***knotan(un)**, beside pl. gen. ***knotnō(n)** > ***knottō(n)**, dat. ***knotnum-** > ***knottum-**. This interchange between the single and double consonants gave rise to levelling in a twofold direction, so that one or other of the forms was transferred to all cases; thus in OE.

the forms with double consonants were generalized in words like **bucca,** *he-goat*; **cnotta,** *knot*; **ēarwicga,** *earwig*; **ebba,** *ebb*; **frogga,** *frog*; **lappa** (**læppa**), *lappet*; **scucca,** *demon*; **stagga,** *stag*; **sugga,** *water wagtail*; and the forms with single consonant in words like **boga,** *bow*; **cnafa** beside OHG. **knabo, knappo,** *boy, youth*; **draca** (Lat. **draco**) beside OHG. **trahho, traccho,** *dragon*; **dropa** beside OHG. **troffo, tropfo,** *drop*; **nama,** *name*; **nefa,** *nephew*; **wita,** *wise man.*

CHAPTER X

THE OE. DEVELOPMENT OF THE GENERAL GERMANIC CONSONANT-SYSTEM

§ **257.** Before entering upon the history of the individual consonants, it will be well to treat here several points concerning the OE. consonants in general.

§ **258.** In OE. as in the oldest period of the other Germanic languages, intervocalic double consonants were really long, and were pronounced long as in Modern Italian and Swedish, thus OE. **buc·ca,** *he-goat*; **set·tan,** *to set*; and similarly **cyssan,** *to kiss*; **feallan,** *to fall*; **feorran,** *from afar*; **frogga,** *frog*; **hebban,** *to raise*; **lecgan,** *to lay*; **sceþþan,** *to injure*; **scieppan,** *to create*; **þennan,** *to stretch*; **swimman,** *to swim.*

§ **259.** OE double consonants were simplified in pronunciation, although they were very often retained in writing, especially finally:—

1. Finally, as **buc,** *buck,* **cos,** *kiss,* **eal,** *all,* **feor,** *far,* **man,** *man,* beside **bucc, coss, eall, feorr, mann; fæsten,** *fortress,* **gyden,** *goddess,* **sǣwet,** *sowing,* beside gen. **fæstennes, gydenne, sǣwettes.** **cg** was always preserved in writing in order to show that it was an explosive and

not a spirant (cp. § **323**), as **brycg**, *bridge*; **mycg**, *midge*; **secg**, *man*. In this grammar the double consonants are generally retained in writing, as **cinn**, *chin*; **full**, *full*; **hyll**, *hill*; **pytt**, *pit*; **sceatt**, *treasure, money*; **synn**, *sin*; **swamm**, *he swam*.

2. Medially before other consonants, as acc. masc. sing. **ealne**, gen. dat. fem. sing. **ealre**, *all*, beside **eallne**, **eallre**; pret. sing. **āfierde**, **cyste**, **fylde**, **ypte**, beside inf. **āfierran**, *to remove*, **cyssan**, *to kiss*, **fyllan**, *to fill*, **yppan**, *to reveal*; third pers. sing. pres. indic. **fielþ**, **gielþ**, **onginþ**, **swimþ**, **winþ**, beside inf. **feallan**, *to fall*, **giellan**, *to yell*, **onginnan**, *to begin*, **swimman**, *to swim*; **winnan**, *to fight*.

3. Medially after consonants, as **geornes** from **georn** + **nes**, *zeal*; **gesynto** from ***gesynttu**, older ***gisundiþu**, *health*; **þearlic** from **þearl** + **līc**, *severe*; **wiersa** from ***wierssa**, older ***wiers(i)ra**, *worse*; **wilder**, **wildēor** from **wild** + **dēor**, *wild beast*; **wyrtruma** from **wyrt** + **truma**, *root-stump*; pret. sing. **gewielde** from ***gewield-de**, **gyrde** from ***gyrd-de**, **læste** from ***læst-te**, **reste** from ***rest-te**, **sende** from ***send-de**, **wende** from ***wend-de**, beside inf. **gewieldan**, *to subdue*, **gyrdan**, *to gird*, **læstan**, *to perform*, **restan**, *to rest*, **sendan**, *to send*, **wendan**, *to turn*.

4. In late OE. in unstressed syllables, as **bliccetan**, *to glitter*, **līccetan**, *to pretend, feign*, beside **bliccettan**, **liccettan**; **atelic**, *terrible*, **singalīce**, *always*, **yfelic**, *bad*, beside **atollic**, **singallīce**, **yfellic**; **forgiefenes**, *forgiveness*, **forlorenes**, *destruction*, beside **forgiefennes**, **forlorennes**; gen. sing. **fæstenes**, *of a fortress*, **sǣwetes**, *of a sowing*, beside **fæstennes**, **sǣwettes**; gen. pl. **ōþera**, *other*, **snot(t)era**, *prudent, wise*, beside **ōþerra**, **snot(t)erra**; **fægera** beside **fægerra**, *fairer*.

§ **260.** Consonants were doubled during the OE. period before a following **r** or **l**, with shortening of a preceding long vowel or diphthong, as **ætgæddre**, *together*, **blæddre**, *bladder*, **æddre**, *vein*, **gegaddrode**, *he gathered*, **næddre**,

adder, beside older **ætgæd(e)re, blǣdre, ǣdre, gegad(e)rode, nǣdre**; comparative **bettra**, *better*, **deoppra**, *deeper*, **geliccra**, *more like*, **hwittra**, *whiter*, **riccra**, *more powerful*, **yttra**, *outer*, beside older **bet(e)ra, dēopra, gelīcra, hwītra, rīcra, ȳtra.** Gen. **miccles** beside older **micles**, nom. **micel**, *great*. In words like **attor**, *poison*, **foddor**, *food*, **moddor**, *mother*, **tuddor**, *progeny*, beside older **ātor, fōdor, mōdor, tūdor**, the doubling of the consonant went out from the inflected forms, as gen. **ātres**, nom. pl. **mōdru**, which regularly became **attres, moddru** and from which a new nom. **attor, moddor** was formed. On a similar doubling of consonants in West Germanic, see § **255.**

§ **261.** The Germanic voiceless spirants, **f, þ, s** became the voiced spirants **ƀ, đ, z** medially between voiced sounds, although the **f, þ, s** were retained in writing, as **cēafl**, *jaw*; **ofen**, *oven*; **wulfas**, *wolves*, § **296**; **āþas**, *oaths*; **brōþor**, *brother*; **eorþe**, *earth*, § **302**; **bōsm**, *bosom*; **nosu**, *nose*; **ōsle**, *ousel*, § **307.**

NOTE.—This voicing of **f, þ, s** only took place in simple words, but not in compounds, such as **āþwēan**, *to wash*; **gefeoht**, *battle*; **gesendan**, *to send*; **wynsum**, *pleasant.*

§ **262.** The Germanic voiced spirants **ƀ, ȝ** became the voiceless spirants **f** (§ **294**), **χ** (§§ **320**, Note, **323**) before voiceless sounds and finally, as **geaf**, OHG. **gab**, *he gave*; **healf**, OHG. **halb**, *half*; **wīf**, OHG. **wīb**, *woman, wife*; **burh**, *city*, **sorh**, *sorrow*, **dāh**, *dough*, **bēah**, *ring, bracelet*, beside gen. **burge, sorge, dāges, bēages**; **stīhst** beside older **stīgest**, *thou ascendest.*

THE SEMIVOWELS.

w

§ **263.** Germanic **w** = the **w** in NE. **wet** (generally written **uu, u, ƿ** in OE. manuscripts) remained initially before vowels, and generally also initially before and after

consonants, as **wæs**, Goth. OS. OHG. **was**, *was*; OE. OS. Goth. **witan**, OHG. **wiȝȝan**, *to know*; and similarly **wadan**, *to go, wade*; **wascan**, *to wash*; **wǣpen**, *weapon*; **wǣron**, *were*; **wæter**, *water*; **wearm**, *warm*; **weder**, *weather*; **wefan**, *to weave*; **weorþan**, *to become*; **wīd**, *wide*; **wilde**, *wild*; **windan**, *to wind*; **winter**, *winter*; **wolcen**, *cloud*; **wundor**, *wonder*; **wyrcan**, *to work*.

wlanc, *proud*; **wlite**, OS. **wliti**, *form, beauty*, Goth. **wlits**, *face, countenance*; **wlitig**, *beautiful*; **wracu**, Goth. **wraka**, *revenge, persecution*; **wrāþ**, *angry*; **wrītan**, *to write*.

cwēn, Goth. **qēns**, *queen, wife*; **cweþan**, Goth. **qiþan**, *to say*; **hwā**, Goth. **hvas**, *who?*; **hwǣte**, Goth. **hváiteis**, *wheat*; **dwellan**, OHG. **twellen**, *to tarry*; **dweorg**, OHG. **twerg**, *dwarf*; **þwēan**, Goth. **þwahan**, *to wash*; **þweorh**, Goth. **þwaírhs**, *angry, perverse*; **sweltan**, Goth. **swiltan**, *to die*; **sweostor**, Goth. **swistar**, *sister*; **twā**, Goth. **twái**, *two*; **twelf**, Goth. **twalif**, *twelve*.

§ **264.** Medial **w** generally remained before vowels, as OE. OS. OHG. **spīwan**, Goth. **speiwan**, *to vomit, spit*; and similarly **awel**, *awl*; **gesewen**, *seen*; **lāwerce**, *lark*; **sāwol**, Goth. **sáiwala**, *soul*; **snīwan**, *to snow*; **þawian** from ***þawōjan**, *to thaw*, see § **266**. In verbs like **blāwan**, OHG. **blāan** beside **blāian**, *to blow*; **blōwan**, OHG. **bluoan** beside **bluoian**, **bluowen**, *to bloom*; **sāwan**, Goth. **saian**, OHG. **sāan** beside **sāian**, **sāwen**, *to sow*; **wāwan**, Goth. **waian**, OHG. **wāen** beside **wāian**, *to blow* (*of the wind*), it is difficult to determine how far the **w** was etymological and how far it was originally merely a consonantal glide developed between the long and the short vowel; and similarly in **cnāwan**, *to know*; **crāwan**, *to crow*; **flōwan**, *to flow*; **grōwan**, *to grow*; **hlōwan**, *to low*; **māwan**, *to mow*; **rōwan**, *to row*; **þrāwan**, *to twist*.

eowe, *ewe*; **eowestre**, Goth. **awistr**, *sheepfold*; **hweowol**, *wheel*; **meowle**, Goth. **mawilō**, *maiden*; **streowede**,

Goth. **strawida**, *I strewed*; **þeowian**, *to serve*. See §§ **77, 89**.

Gen. sing. **bearwes, bealwes, cneowes, gearwes, snāwes, strawes, treowes, þeowes**, beside nom. **bearu**, *grove*, **bealu**, *evil, calamity*, **cnēo**, *knee*, **gearu**, *ready*, **snā**, *snow*, **strēa**, *straw*, **trēo**, *tree*, **þēo**, *servant*; gen. dat. sing. **læswe, mǣdwe, sceadwe**, beside nom. **læs**, *pasture*, **mǣd**, *meadow*, **sceadu**, *shade, shadow*. See §§ **215, 266**.

frætwan, *to adorn*; **gearwe**, *completely*; **gearwian**, *to prepare*; **nearwe**, *narrowly*; **nierwan**, *to narrow*; **sierwan**, *to devise*; **smierwan**, *to anoint, smear*; **spearwa**, Goth. **sparwa**, *sparrow*; **wealwian**, *to wallow*; **wielwan**, *to roll*.

brēowan, *to brew*, cp. O.Icel. pp. **bruggenn**, *brewed*; **cēowan**, OHG. **kiuwan**, *to chew*; **getrīewe**, *true, faithful*; **getrīewan**, *to trust*; **hēawan**, Goth. ***haggwan**, *to hew*; **nīewe, nīwe**, *new*; **scēawian**, Goth. ***skaggwōn**, *to examine, view*. See §§ **76, 90, 135**.

§ **265**. When **w** came to stand at the end of a word or syllable, it became vocalized to **u** (later **o**). The **u** then combined with a preceding short vowel to form a long diphthong, but disappeared after long stems, long vowels, and diphthongs, as nom. **bealu** (later **bealo**), *evil, calamity*, **bearu**, *grove*, **gearu**, *ready*, **mearu**, *tender*, **nearu**, *narrow*, **searu**, *armour*, beside gen. **bealwes, bearwes, gearwes, mearwes, nearwes, searwes**; masc. acc. sing. **gearone** from ***gearwne**, *ready*. Nom. **cnēo**, *knee*, **strēa**, *straw*, **trēo**, *tree*, **þēo**, *servant*, beside gen. **cneowes, streawes, treowes, þeowes**. **gād**, Goth. **gáidw**, *want, lack*, **ā, ō**, Goth. **áiw**, *ever*; **hrā**, Goth. **hráiw**, *corpse*; **hrēa**, *raw*; **snā**, Goth. **snáiws**, *snow*.

But the **w** was mostly reintroduced into the nom. sing. from the inflected forms, especially after long vowels and long diphthongs. Regular forms were: nom. **cnēo, snā, strēa**, gen. **cneowes, snāwes, streawes**, from the latter

of which was formed a new nom. **cnēow, snāw, strēaw**; and similarly **hrāw**, *corpse*; **hrēaw**, *raw*; **trēow**, *tree*; **þēow**, *servant*; **slāw**, *lazy*; **stōw**, *place*; **bēow**, *barley*; **dēaw**, *dew*; **glēaw**, *wise*; **hīew, hīw**, *shape, colour*; **hnēaw**, *stingy*; **hrēow**, *repentance*; **trēow**, *faith*. And conversely from the new nom. was sometimes formed a new gen., as **cnēowes, trēowes,** beside older **cneowes, treowes.**

§ **266.** **w** disappeared before **u**, and **e** (= older **i**), as nom. **clēa** from ***cla(w)u**, *claw*; **lǣs** from ***lǣs(w)u**, *pasture*; **mǣd** from ***mǣd(w)u**, *meadow*; **sceadu** from ***scad(w)u**, *shade, shadow*; **þrēa** from ***þra(w)u**, *threat*, beside gen. **lǣswe, mǣdwe, sceadwe**; nom. acc. neut. **fēa** from ***fa(w)u**, *few*; dat. **fēam** from ***fa(w)um**, see § **140**; dat. pl. **cnēom** from ***cne(w)um**, beside nom. sing. **cnēo**, *knee*. And similarly at a later period: **betuh**, *between*, **cucu**, *quick, alive*, **cudu**, *cud*, **uton**, *let us*, beside older **betwuh, cwucu, cwudu, wuton.**

cū from ***k(w)ū**, older ***kwō**, *cow*; **hū** from ***h(w)ū**, older ***hwō**, *how*; neut. **tū** from ***t(w)ū**, older ***twō**, *two*. See § **130.**

ǣ from ***ā(w)i·**, older ***aiwi·** (Goth. **áiws**), *law*; **hrǣ** from ***hrā(w)i·**, older ***hraiwi·**, *corpse*; **sǣ** from ***sā(w)i·**, older ***saiwi·** (Goth. **sáiws**), *sea*; **giereþ**, prim. Germanic ***garwiþ**, *he prepares*; pret. **gierede**, prim. Germanic ***garwiđē·**, *he prepared*, beside inf. **gierwan**; and similarly pret. **nierede, sierede, smierede, wielede,** beside inf. **nierwan**, *to narrow*; **sierwan**, *to devise*; **smierwan**, *to anoint*; **wielwan**, *to roll*.

The **w** was often reintroduced after the analogy of forms where **w** was regular, as nom. **clawu, þrawu** (beside the regular nom. **clēa, þrēa**), new formations from the gen. and dat. **clawe, þrawe**; dat. pl. **sǣwum** beside **sǣm,** with **w** from the gen. pl. **sǣwa**, *of seas*; pret. pl. **rēowun** beside **rēon,** with **w** from **rōwan**, *to row*; and similarly

grēowun, ·on, *they grew*; **sēowun,** *they sowed*; &c. On forms like pret. pl. **swulton,** *they died*; **swummon,** *they swam,* see § **249.** **gierweþ,** *he prepares,* pret. **gierwede,** beside the regular forms **giereþ, gierede,** with **w** from **gierwan**; **cnǣwþ** for ***cnǣþ** from ***cnā(w)iþ,** *he knows,* with **w** from the inf. **cnāwan.**

§ **267.** **w** often disappeared in the second element of compounds **ealneg, ·ig,** for **ealne weg,** *always*; **fulluht** from ***full wuht,** *baptism*; **hlāford** from ***hlāf weard,** *lord*; **hwīlende** from ***hwīl wende,** *transitory*; **nāuht** beside older **nā·wuht,** *naught.* And in certain verbal forms with the negative prefix, as **næs** = **ne wæs,** *was not*; **nǣron** = **ne wǣron,** *were not*; **nāt** = **ne wāt,** *knows not*; **nolde** = **ne wolde,** *would not*; **nyle** = **ne wile,** *will not*; **nysse** = **ne wisse,** *he knew not*; **nyton** = **ne witon,** *they know not.*

j

§ **268.** Germanic **j** (= consonantal **i**) generally remained initially in Gothic, OS. and OHG., but disappeared in O.Icel. In OE. it had become a palatal spirant like the **y** in NE. **yet, yon** already in the oldest period of the language. It was usually written **g, ge** (also **i, gi** before a following **u**). Examples are: **gēar,** Goth. **jēr,** OS. OHG. **jār,** O.Icel. **ār,** *year*; **geoc, iuc,** Goth. **juk,** OHG. **joch,** O.Icel. **ok,** *yoke*; **geong, giong, giung, iung,** Goth. **juggs,** OS. OHG. **jung,** O.Icel. **ungr,** *young*; and similarly **gē, gīe,** *ye*; **gēo, gīo, iū,** *formerly, of old*; **geogoþ, giogoþ, iugoþ,** *youth*; **geōmor,** *sad, mournful*; **geond,** *through, beyond*; **giest,** *yeast*; **gingra,** *younger.* See § **51.**

§ **269.** Germanic medial **·ij·** became **·ī·** which combined with a following guttural vowel to form a diphthong, as **bīo, bēo,** Germanic stem-form ***bijōn·,** *bee*; **fēond,** Goth. **fijands,** *enemy*; **frēo** from ***frija·,** *free*; **frēond,**

Goth. **frijōnds**, *friend*; nom. acc. neut. **þrīo**, **þrēo**, from ***þriju** = Goth. **þrija**, *three*, see § **104**.

§ **270**. It is generally assumed that Germanic **j** remained in OE. between vowels when the first element was a long vowel or diphthong, but it is, however, more probable that **j** regularly disappeared in this position and that at a later period a consonantal glide (written **g**, **ge**) was developed between the vowels, as was sometimes the case in OS. and OHG., as **cīegan** from ***kaujan**, *to call*; **frīgea** older **frīegea** = Goth. **fráuja**, *lord, master*; dat. **hīege**, Anglian **hēge** = Goth. **háuja**, **īege** = Goth. ***áujái**, beside nom. **hīeg**, *hay*, **īeg**, *island*; **þrēagean** from ***þrauōjan**, *to threaten*; and similarly **fēog(e)an**, *to hate*; **frēog(e)an**, *to love*. Cp. § **275**.

NOTE.—Forms like nom. **hīeg**, Goth. **hawi**, *hay*; **īeg**, **īg**, Goth. ***awi**, gen. ***áujōs**, had the final **g** from the inflected forms, as gen. **hīeges**, dat. **hīege**, gen. and dat. **īege**.

§ **271**. Germanic medial **j** (written **i**, **g**; **ig**, **eg**, also **ige** before **a**) remained after **r** in the combination short vowel + **r**, as **herian**, **hergan**, **herigan**, **heregan**, **herigean**, Goth. **hazjan**, *to praise*; and similarly **nerian**, Goth. **nasjan**, *to save*; **werian**, Goth. **wasjan**, *to clothe, wear*; gen. sing. **heries**, **herges**, **heriges**, Goth. **harjis**, nom. pl. **hergas**, **herigas**, **herigeas**, Goth. **harjōs**, *armies*. The **i**, **e** in **ig**, **eg** represent a vocalic glide which was developed between the **r** and the **j**. And the **e** in **ige** merely indicates the palatal nature of the preceding **g**.

§ **272**. Germanic medial **j** disappeared after original long closed syllables or syllables which became long by the West Germanic gemination of consonants (§ **254**), as **dǣlan**, Goth. **dáiljan**, *to divide*; **dēman**, Goth. **dōmjan**, *to judge*; **fyllan**, Goth. **fulljan**, *to fill*; **gelīefan**, Goth. **galáubjan**, *to believe*; **hīeran**, Goth. **háusjan**, *to hear*; **sēcan**, Goth. **sōkjan**, *to seek*. **gierd** from ***geardju** = Goth.

***gardja**, *rod, twig*; **hild** from ***hildju** = Goth. ***hildja**, *war*; gen. **rīces** from ***rīkjes**, Goth. **reikjis**, *of a kingdom.*

biddan, Goth. **bidjan**, *to pray*; **hebban**, Goth. **hafjan**, *to raise*; **hliehhan**, Goth. **hlahjan**, *to laugh*; **lecgan**, Goth. **lagjan**, *to lay*; **scieppan**, Goth. **skapjan**, *to create*; **settan**, Goth. **satjan**, *to set.* Gen. sing. **beddes**, Goth. **badjis**, *of a bed*; **cynnes**, Goth. **kunjis**, *of a race, generation*; **willa**, Goth. **wilja**, *will*; **henn** from ***hennju**, older ***χannjō** = Goth. ***hanja**, *hen*; and similarly **crycc**, Goth. ***krukja**, *crutch*; **hell**, Goth. **halja**, *hell*; **sibb**, Goth. **sibja**, *relationship*; gen. **helle**, **sibbe** = Goth. **haljōs**, **sibjōs**.

NOTE.—**j** disappeared medially before **i** already in West Germanic; hence verbs, which have double consonants in the inf. by the West Germanic gemination of consonants, have only a single consonant in the second and third pers. sing. of the present indicative, as **legest**, **legeþ** = Goth. **lagjis**, **lagjiþ**, beside inf. **lecgan** = Goth. **lagjan**, *to lay.*

§ **273.** Germanic final **-ōjan** became **-ian** through the intermediate stages **-ējan**, **ejan**, **-ijan**, **-īan**, as **lōcian** from ***lōkōjan**, *to look*; **macian** from ***makōjan**, *to make.* The **g** in forms like **lōcig(e)an**, **macig(e)an** is merely a consonantal glide which was developed between the **i** and the **a**.

The Germanic ending **-ij(i)** from Indg. **-eje** became **-ī** during the prim. Germanic period, then **-ī** became shortened **-i** (§ **214**). This **-i** regularly disappeared in prehistoric OE. after original long stems, but remained **-i** (later **e**) after original short stems, as **hīer**, Goth. **hausei**, from ***χauzī**, *hear thou*; **sēc**, Goth **sōkei**, *seek thou*; but **nere**, Goth. **nasei**, *save thou*; and similarly **bide**, *pray thou*; **freme**, *perform thou*; **lege**, *lay thou*; **sete**, *set thou.*

§ **274.** When **j** came to stand finally after the loss of the case endings **-az**, **-an** (= Indg. **-os**, **-om**), it became vocalized to **-i** which became **-e** at a later period, as **hierde**, OS. **hirdi**, OHG. **hirti**, Goth. (acc.) **haírdi**, *shepherd*; and similarly **ende**, *end*; **here**, *army*; **læce**, *physician*; **rīce**,

OS. **rīki**, OHG. **rīhhi**, Goth. **reiki**, *kingdom*; **wīte**, OS. **wīti**, *punishment*. The regularly developed forms of **hrycg**, *back*, **secg**, *man*, **bedd**, *bed*, **cynn**, *race, generation*, **nett**, *net*, and of similar masculine and neuter nouns with double consonants in the nom. and acc. singular, would be ***hryge**, Goth. (acc.) ***hrugi**; ***sege**, Goth. (acc.) ***sagi**; ***bede**, Goth. **badi**; ***cyne**, Goth. **kuni**; ***nete**, Goth. **nati**. The nom. and acc. sing. are new formations with double consonants from the inflected stem-forms.

§ **275.** Germanic **jj** became **ddj** in Goth. and **gg(j)** in O.Icel. In OE. **-ijj-** became **-ī-** through the intermediate stage **-ij-**; and **-ajj-** became **-ǣ-** through the intermediate stages **-aij-**, **-āj-**. And then between the **-ī-**, **-ǣ-** and a following vowel a consonantal glide (written **g**) was developed (cp. § **270**), which was often levelled out into the uninflected forms, as **frīgedæg**, **frīgdæg**, *Friday*, beside **frēo** from ***frīo**, older ***frījō**, OS. **frī**, *woman*; **ēode** from ***īode**, older ***ījō-dǣ-**, Goth. **iddja**, *he went*; gen. **ǣges**, **cǣge**, **wǣge**, beside nom. **ǣg** (O.Icel. **egg**, OS. OHG. **ei**), *egg*, **cǣg**, *key*, **wǣg** (Goth. **waddjus**, O.Icel. **veggr**), *wall*; **clǣg**, Goth. (fem.) ***kladdja**, OS. **klei**, *clay*.

The Liquids.

1

§ **276.** Germanic **l** generally remained in OE. both initially, medially, and finally, as **lecgan**, Goth. **lagjan**, O.Icel. **leggja**, OS. **leggian**, OHG. **leggen**, *to lay*; **slǣpan**, Goth. **slēpan**, OS. **slāpan**, OHG. **slāfan**, *to sleep*; OE. OS. OHG. **stelan**, Goth. **stilan**, O.Icel. **stela**, *to steal*; OE. OS. **helpan**, Goth. **hilpan**, O.Icel. **hjalpa**, OHG. **helfan**, *to help*; **sellan**, Goth. **saljan**, O.Icel. **selja**, OS. **sellian**, OHG. **sellen**, *to give, sell*; **feallan**, O.Icel. **falla**, OS. OHG. **fallan**, *to fall*; **sceal**, Goth. O.Icel. OS.

OHG. **skal**, *shall*; and similarly **lamb**, *lamb*; **land**, *land*; **lang**, *long*; **lǣdan**, *to lead*; **lēof**, *dear*; **leornian**, *to learn*; **līf**, *life*; **lufu**, *love*; **lȳtel**, *little*. **ealu**, *ale*; **meolu**, *meal*; **mioluc**, *milk*; **talu**, *number, tale*. **blōd**, *blood*; **clǣne**, *clean*; **flēon**, *to flee*; **glæd**, *glad*; **hlāford**, *lord*; **wlonc**, *proud*. **feld**, *field*; **folc**, *folk*; **folgian**, *to follow*; **gold**, *gold*; **helm**, *helmet*; **meltan**, *to melt*; **wealdan**, *to wield, govern*. **stille**, *still, silent*; **tellan**, *to tell*; **willa**, *will*. **fyllan**, *to fill*; **gealla**, *gall*; **weallan**, *to boil*; **wulle**, *wool*. **col**, *coal*; **cōl**, *cool*; **fūl**, *foul*; **fugol**, *fowl, bird*; **smæl**, *slender*; **sadol**, *saddle*; **stæl**, *he stole*. **hyll**, *hill*. **eall**, *all*; **full**, *full*.

On vocalic **l** as in **æpl**, *apple*; **nǣdl**, *needle*; **nægl**, *nail*; **segl**, *sail*; **setl**, *seat*, see § **219**.

§ **277**. **sl** underwent metathesis in unstressed syllables, as **byrgels**, OS. **burgisli**, *tomb*; **rǣdels**, OS. **rādislo**, MHG. **rætsel**, *riddle*; and similarly **brīdels**, *bridle*; **fǣtels**, *tub, vessel*; **gyrdels** older **gyrdisl**, *girdle*; **rīecels**, *incense*. Metathesis of **l** rarely took place in stem-syllables, as Anglian **bold**, *dwelling*, **seld**, *seat*, **spāld**, *saliva*, beside WS. **botl**, **setl**, **spātl**.

r

§ **278**. Germanic **r** generally remained in OE. both initially, medially, and finally, as **rēad**, Goth. **ráuþs**, O.Icel. **rauðr**, OS. **rōd**, OHG. **rōt**, *red*; OE. OS. OHG. **bringan**, Goth. **briggan**, *to bring*; **here**, Goth. **harjis**, OS. OHG. **heri**, *army*; OE. OS. **word**, Goth. **waúrd**, OHG. **wort**, *word*; **feorran**, *from afar*, Goth. **faírra**, *far off*; **fæder**, Goth. OS. **fadar**, O.Icel. **faðir**, OHG. **fater**, *father*; and similarly **rǣdan**, *to advise*; **rāp**, *rope*; **regn**, *rain*; **rīce**, *kingdom*; **rīdan**, *to ride*; **rīm**, *number*; **rodor**, *sky*; **rūm**, *room*. **crēopan**, *to creep*; **drēam**, *mirth*; **frēo**, *free*; **grēne**, *green*; **hrōf**, *roof*; **strēam**, *stream*; **trēo**, *tree*; **wrītan**, *to write*. **beran**, *to bear*; **cearu**, *care, sorrow*; **duru**, *door*; **faran**, *to go, travel*. **bierce**, *birch*; **burg**, *city*;

earm, *arm*; **eorþe**, *earth*; **feorh**, *life*; **heard**, *hard*; **scearp**, *sharp*; **spearwa**, *sparrow*; **steorfan**, *to die*; **þorn**, *thorn*; **þurh**, *through*; **weorc**, *work* **āfierran**, *to remove*; **steorra**, *star*. **fȳr**, *fire*; **hamor**, *hammer*; **mōdor**, *mother*; **tēar**, *tear*; **wer**, *man*.

NOTE —**r** disappeared in late OE. in **specan**, *to speak*, **spǣc**, *speech*, beside older **sprecan**, **sprǣc**.

§ **279.** West Germanic medial **r** from older **z** (§ **252**) remained in OE., as **betra**, Goth. **batiza**, *better*; **herian**, Goth. **hazjan**, *to praise*; **hord**, Goth. **huzd**, *treasure*; and similarly **coren**, *chosen*; **dēor** (Goth. **dius**, gen. **diuzis**), *deer, wild animal*; **ēare**, *ear*; **hīeran**, *to hear*; **ieldra**, *elder*; **lǣran**, *to teach*; **leornian**, *to learn*; **māra**, *larger*; **nerian**, *to save*; **wǣron**, *they were*. **ierre**, Goth. **aírzeis**, OS. OHG. **irri**, *angry*; and similarly ***durran**, *to dare*; **mierran**, *to hinder, mar*; **þyrre**, *dry, withered*.

§ **280.** Antevocalic **r** often became postvocalic by metathesis when a short vowel was followed by **n**, **nn**, **s**, or **s** + consonant, as **ærn**, Goth. **razn**, O.Icel. **rann**, *house*; **forsc**, O.Icel. **froskr**, OHG. **frosk**, *frog*; **forst**, O.Icel. OS. OHG. **frost**, *frost*; **hors**, O.Icel. OS. **hross**, OHG. **ros** (gen. **rosses**), *horse*; **iernan**, Goth. OS. OHG. **rinnan**, O.Icel. **rinna**, *to run*; and similarly **bærnan** (wv.), **biernan** (sv.), *to burn*; **bærs**, *perch* (*a fish*); **berstan**, *to burst*; **cærse**, *cress*; **fersc**, *fresh*; **fierst**, *space of time*; **gærs**, *grass*; **hærn**, *wave*; **þerscan**, *to thresh* (*corn*); **wærna** beside **wrænna**, *wren*.

§ **281.** **s** or **l** + **r** became **ss**, **ll** by assimilation, as **lǣssa** from ***lǣs(i)ra**, *smaller*; fem. gen. dat. sing. **þisse** (OHG. **desera**, **desero**), from ***þisre**, *of this*; gen. pl. **þissa** (OHG. **desero**), from ***þisra**; gen. sing. **ūsses** from ***ūsres**, *of our*; dat. **ūssum** from ***ūsrum**. **sēlla** beside **sēlra**, *better*.

The Nasals.

m

§ **282.** Germanic **m** generally remained in OE. both initially, medially, and finally, as **mōna**, Goth. **mēna**, O.Icel. **māne**, OS. OHG. **māno**, *moon*; OE. Goth. **guma**, O.Icel. **gume**, OS. **gumo**, OHG. **gomo**, *man*; OE. OS. **dumb**, Goth. **dumbs**, O.Icel. **dumbr**, OHG. **tumb**, *dumb*; OE. O.Icel. OS. OHG. **rūm**, *room*; and similarly **macian**, *to make*; **mann**, *man*; **māwan**, *to mow*; **meltan**, *to melt*; **mīn**, *my*; **mōdor**, *mother*; **mūþ**, *mouth*. **cuman**, *to come*; **nama**, *name*; **niman**, *to take*; **tīma**, *time*; **þūma**, *thumb*. **besma**, *besom*; **climban**, *to climb*; **gelimpan**, *to happen*; **lamb**, *lamb*. **fremman** from ***framjan**, *to perform*; **swimman**, *to swim*. **bēam**, *tree*; **brōm**, *broom*; **hām**, *home*; **helm**, *helmet*; **wyrm**, *snake*. **swamm**, *he swam*.

On vocalic **m** as in **æþm**, *breath*; **bōsm**, *bosom*; **botm**, *bottom*; **māþm**, *treasure*, see § **219**.

§ **283.** **m** disappeared in prehistoric OE. before **f**, **s** with lengthening of the preceding vowel, as **fīf**, Goth. OHG. **fimf**, *five*; **ōsle**, OHG. **amsala**, *ousel*; **sōfte**, OHG. **samfto**, *softly*; **sēfte**, *soft*. But **m** remained when it came to stand before **s** at a later period, as **grimsian** from ***grimisian** = OHG. **grimmisōn**, *to rage*; **þrims** beside older **trimes**, **trymesse** (OHG. **drimissa**), *a coin*.

§ **284.** Final **-m**, when an element of inflexion, became **-n** in late OE., as dat. pl. **dagon**, **giefon**, **sunon** beside older **dagum**, **giefum**, **sunum**; dat. sing. and pl. **gōdon** beside older **gōdum**, *good*.

n

§ **285.** Germanic **n** generally remained in OE. both initially, medially, and finally, as **nama**, Goth. **namō**, OS. OHG. **namo**, *name*; OE. OS. OHG. **sunu**, Goth. **sunus**, O.Icel. **sunr**, *son*; OE. Goth. OHG. **spinnan**, O.Icel. **spinna**, *to spin*; **þennan**, OS. **thennian**, OHG. **dennen**,

Goth. **þanjan**, O.Icel. **þenja**, *to stretch*; and similarly **nacod**, *naked*; **nǣdl**, *needle*; **nefa**, *nephew*; **nett**, *net*. **clǣne**, *clean*; **grēne**, *green*; **mōna**, *moon*; **munuc**, *monk*; **wēnan**, *to expect*. **bindan**, *to bind*; **blind**, *blind*; **cnēo**, *knee*; **frēond**, *friend*; **hand**, *hand*; **hnutu**, *nut*; **sendan**, *to send*; **windan**, *to wind*. **spannan**, *to clasp*; **sunne**, *sun*; **þynn(e)**, *thin*. **bān**, *bone*; **cwēn**, *queen*; **heofon**, *heaven*; **mylen**, *mill*; **stān**, *stone*. **cinn**, *chin*; **henn**, *hen*; **mann**, *man*; **synn**, *sin*.

On vocalic **n** as in **hræfn**, *raven*; **regn**, *rain*; **tācn**, *token*, see § **219**.

§ **286**. **n** disappeared in prehistoric OE. before **þ**, **s** with lengthening of the preceding vowel, as **cūþ**, Goth. **kunþs**, OHG. **kund**, *known*; **ēst**, Goth. **ansts**, OHG. **anst**, stem-form **ansti-**, *favour*; **ōþer**, Goth. **anþar**, OHG. **andar**, *other*; **ūs**, Goth. OHG. **uns**, *us*; and similarly **cȳþan**, *to make known*; **dūst**, *dust*; **fūs**, *ready*; **gesīþ**, *companion*; **gōs**, *goose*; **hōs** (OHG. **hansa**), *band, escort*; **mūþ**, *mouth*; **sīþ**, *journey*; **tōþ**, *tooth*; **wȳscan**, *to wish*; **ȳst**, *storm*. The long vowel became shortened in unstressed syllables, as **fracuþ**, **-oþ**, Goth. **frakunþs**, *despised*; and similarly **duguþ**, *strength, valour*; **geoguþ**, *youth*; **nimaþ** from ***nimōþ**, older ***nemonþ-**, *they take*, see § **218**. But **n** remained when it came to stand before **s** at a later period, as **clǣnsian** from ***clǣnisian**, older ***klainisōjan**, *to cleanse*; **minsian** from ***minnisian**, *to diminish*; **winster** older **winester** (OHG. **winister**), *left, left hand*; also in the Latin loanword **pinsian** (Lat. **pensāre**), *to consider*.

§ **287**. **n** sometimes disappeared between consonants, as **elboga** beside **elnboga**, *elbow*; pret. **nemde** from ***nemnde**, *he named*; **sæterdæg** beside **sæterndæg**, *Saturday*.

§ **288**. Final **-n** generally disappeared in verbal forms before the pronouns **wē**, **wit**; **gē**, **git**, as **binde wē**, *let us bind*; **binde gē**, *bind ye!*; **bunde wē?**, *did we bind?*. See § **477**.

Final **-n** disappeared in Nth. in words of more than one syllable. This law was fairly well preserved in the infinitive, the pres. and pret. pl. subjunctive, the weak declension of nouns and adjectives, numerals, and adverbs, but in strong nouns and adjectives including the pp. of strong verbs, the final **-n** was generally reintroduced into the nom. singular from the inflected forms. It was also mostly reintroduced into the indic. pret. plural through the influence of the (?)past participle which itself was a new formation. Examples are: **bera,** *to bear,* **gehēra,** *to hear,* **lǣra,** *to teach,* **senda,** *to send* = WS. **beran, gehīeran, lǣran, sendan; gihēre,** *they may hear,* **sprece,** *they may speak* = WS. **gehīeren, sprecen; bite,** *they might bite* = WS. **biten;** gen. dat. acc. sing. **fola,** *foal,* **heorta,** *heart* = WS. **folan, heortan;** nom. acc. pl. **galga** = WS. **gealgan,** *gallows;* **seofo** beside inflected form **seofona,** *seven;* **befora,** *before,* **binna,** *within,* **fearra,** *from afar,* **norþa,** *from the north,* **westa,** *from the west* = WS. **beforan, binnan, feorran, norþan, westan;** but **dryhten,** *lord,* **heofon,** *heaven,* **hēþen,** *heathen,* **ārisen,** *arisen,* **genumen,** *taken,* with **-n** from the inflected forms; **bērun,** *they bore,* **cwōmun,** *they came,* **lǣddun,** *they led.*

ŋ

§ **289.** The Germanic guttural nasal **ŋ** (written **g** in Gothic, and **n** in the other Germanic languages) only occurred medially before **g** and **k** (written **c** in OE.). It disappeared in the combination **ŋx** already in prim. Germanic (§ **245**). In OE. it remained guttural or became palatal according as the following **g, c** remained guttural or became palatal, cp. § **309.** Examples are: OE. OHG. **bringan,** Goth. **briggan,** *to bring;* **drincan,** Goth. **drigkan,** OS. **drinkan,** OHG. **trinkan,** *to drink;* **geong,** Goth. **juggs,** O.Icel. **ungr,** OS. OHG. **jung,** *young;* and similarly **finger,** *finger;* **gangan,** *to go;* **hangian,** *to hang;* **hungor,**